

Recreating an ETF, share by share.

We buy and manage the Nasdaq-100's individual shares ourselves, then compare Irish taxes with owning an ETF. Target the full index; rebalance with fresh cash using dated weights. Tax rules and data gaps allow drift.

HIGHEST SELECTED RESULT

€998,425

**Sell losses weekly;
sell and rebuy current stocks
in December**

+€247,696

versus the ETF

+€45,806

versus the stock baseline

After liquidation, taxes and costs.

Hold the ETF

Fund tax on gains, including eight-year deemed disposal.

€750,729

Buy index shares; keep stocks that leave

No voluntary sales before the final sale of everything.

€952,619

Sell losing shares each month

Sell eligible losses; no December sales to use the exemption.

€988,601

Sell losses monthly; sell former index stocks first in December

Then sell and rebuy eligible current stocks to use remaining exemption.

€994,222

Sell losses weekly; sell and rebuy current stocks in December

Sell at a covered profit; rebuy to reset the purchase cost for future CGT.

€998,425

All three active stock strategies: review former index stocks quarterly; sell only when the sale adds no CGT.

December profit sales use existing losses first, then the remaining €1,270 exemption. Eligibility limits apply.

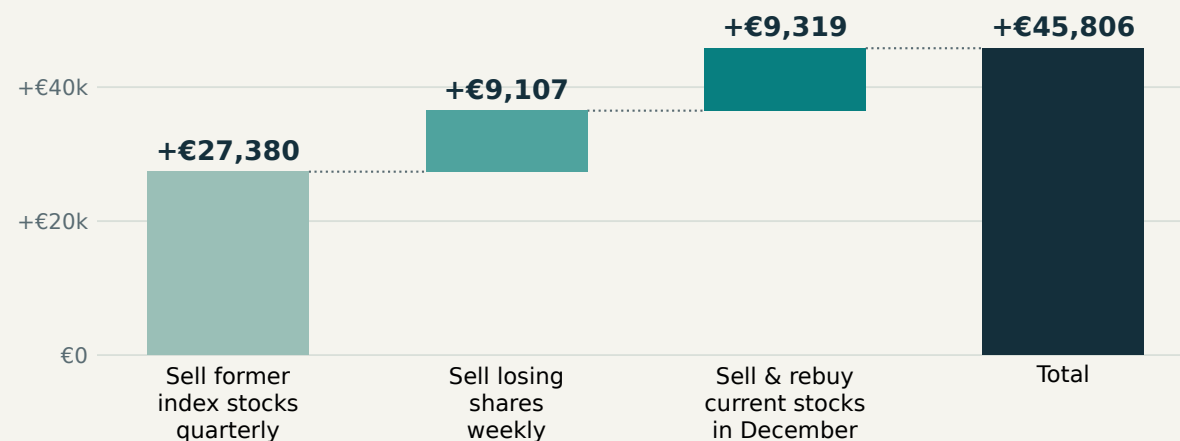
€210,936.48 invested / 192 payments / 16 years. Nominal wealth; differences include holdings, costs and tax.

Where the gains came from.

Change one rule at a time; compare complete portfolios after all taxes and costs.

THE WEEKLY STRATEGY, BUILT IN THREE STEPS

€952,619 → €998,425



ALTERNATIVE: CHECK LOSSES MONTHLY

+€8,602: sell losses monthly. Then +€5,621:

sell former index stocks first in December; then sell & rebuy current stocks.

THE ANNUAL EXEMPTION: OFF → ON

Weekly loss sales; December sell & rebuy

+€13,243

change in final wealth

Nominal exemption relief: €6,368

Monthly loss sales; former stocks first

-€700

change in final wealth

Nominal exemption relief: €6,787

The three steps add because each builds on the previous rule. The exemption cards are separate experiments.

Wealth effects include holdings, costs and reinvestment. Nominal relief is exempt gains × 33%.

Loss and gain harvesting interact: effects measured against different controls cannot simply be added.

How we manage our own index portfolio.

Leading strategy: contributions, net dividends and sale proceeds top up eligible index stocks below their target weights.

01 / EVERY FRIDAY

Sell losing shares

Sell a whole holding at $\geq 5\%$ and $\geq \text{€}25$ loss.
No buy of that share class in prior 29 days;
block repurchase for 29 days afterwards.
Reinvest in other current index stocks.

02 / EACH QUARTER

Sell former index stocks

Sell when existing losses and remaining
exemption cover the gain without extra
CGT. Keep other departed holdings.

03 / EACH DECEMBER

Sell and rebuy at a profit

Sell eligible current stocks; buy them back.
Use existing losses, then the remaining
€1,270 exemption, to cover gains. Oldest
shares sell first; no losing lots; fees apply.

Monthly alternative: sell losses monthly. In December, sell former index stocks first; then sell and rebuy current stocks.

Three rules that fell behind.

PREVIOUSLY WEAK RULES, REPLAYED	SHORTFALL VS CONTROL	WHAT CHANGED
Sell even tiny losses (from €1)	—€22,369	1,403 loss sales vs 424; fees and holdings changed.
Keep stocks that leave the index	—€26,624	Kept former constituents; lower tax, lower final wealth.
Sell and rebuy profitable shares monthly	—€37,500	720 gain sales vs 198; the annual allowance stayed fixed.

Controls: sell former stocks quarterly; sell/rebuy current stocks each December. Monthly loss sales for rows 1/3; none for row 2.

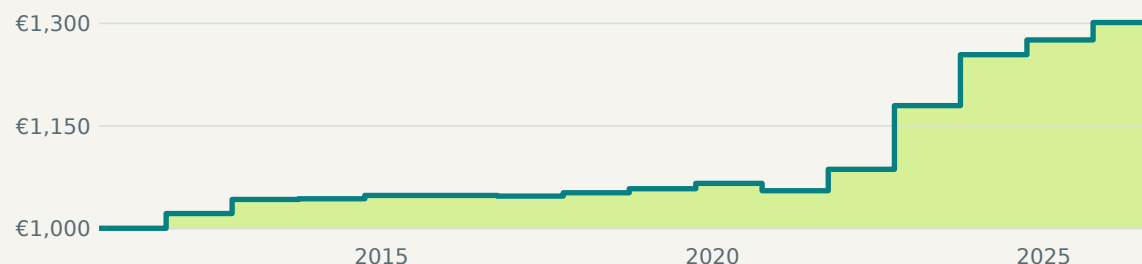
What the comparison assumes.

Same scheduled funding. Frozen tax scenarios. A provisional historical reconstruction.

CONTRIBUTIONS FOLLOW IRISH CPI

€1,000.00 → €1,301.28

Per month / €210,936.48 contributed over 16 years



Each September: €1,000 × August CPI ÷ August 2010 CPI.

Published data only; increases and decreases apply.
Same scheduled flows; three stock deposits post next session.
CSO CPI: December 2006=100; current, non-revised series.

THE TAX SCENARIO

33%

STOCK CAPITAL GAINS

€1,270

ANNUAL CGT EXEMPTION

52.35%

DIVIDEND TAX

38% / 8y

FUND TAX / DEEMED DISPOSAL

No unrelated gains consume the allowance.

READ THE RESULTS AS A BACKTEST

Strategies were selected retrospectively, not out of sample.
Weights, membership and corporate actions remain provisional;
some holdings use nontradable marks. Wealth is nominal.

Research only. Not tax, legal or investment advice.

Methodology, ledgers, source links and legal notice: README + study_manifest.json

COSTS & INTERPRETATION

0.15% FX each non-euro trade; no extra spread or slippage.
ETF NAV includes fund costs. Tax rates are frozen scenarios,
not each year's legislation. See the full modelling limitations.